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Subject: [External] AI Action Plan
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Good evening

I am writing to submit a comment regarding Executive Order 14179 and the AI Action Plan.

The EO is a mistake and the action plan that you develop will be dangerously skewed in favor of large companies at the expense of artists, writers, musicians, and creators of all kinds. Large companies should not have carte blanche to take the creative output of others and sell it as part of AI products. That will diminish the livelihoods of thousands, if not millions, of artists and then will negatively impact small businesses and the economy in general.

We also know that AI processing is energy-intensive and negatively impacts the environment. Damaging the environment, causing droughts and power outages in order to run the servers will also cause damage to the economy at all levels — imagine the stores that can't operate without sufficient power, imagine the family farms that fail if all the water is rerouted to cool servers instead of hydrate crops.

The EO mentions that we must have AI systems free from ideological bias, but algorithms are already biased. Humans wrote the code and humans are biased. We need more guardrails and improvements to ensure bigotry and bias do not proliferate in the code that is written. Books like *Race After Technology* and others detail the racism that is present in so many aspects of our technological world. There are many people who have studied this issue at respected universities and institutions and they have come to the same conclusion — bias is present in technology and AI.

The AI Action Plan could be potentially successful, but in order for that to be the case, you will need to reject fears around the gender spectrum and racial diversity and embrace the concept of consent. Having creators opt in to share materials with AI is much more positive than creators discovering that their art has been scraped without their knowledge or permission. Improving the code and fixing areas where bias against people of color, women, LGBTQ+ folks, older people, and disabled people appear will strengthen the public's faith in this initiative.

If the goal of this administration shifts to wanting make the US better for all 300+ million of us and not just for a handful of billionaires, this push for AI planning could be the start of a reasonable, humane, consent-based model that would guide other countries towards responsible and effective AI adoption. However, if only CEOs have a voice and the only values are short-term gains and profit, then this will only alienate and negatively impact our country.

This plan must benefit the many, not just the few, or it isn't a plan at all, it's just theft and destruction.

Thank you

DF Zulida

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